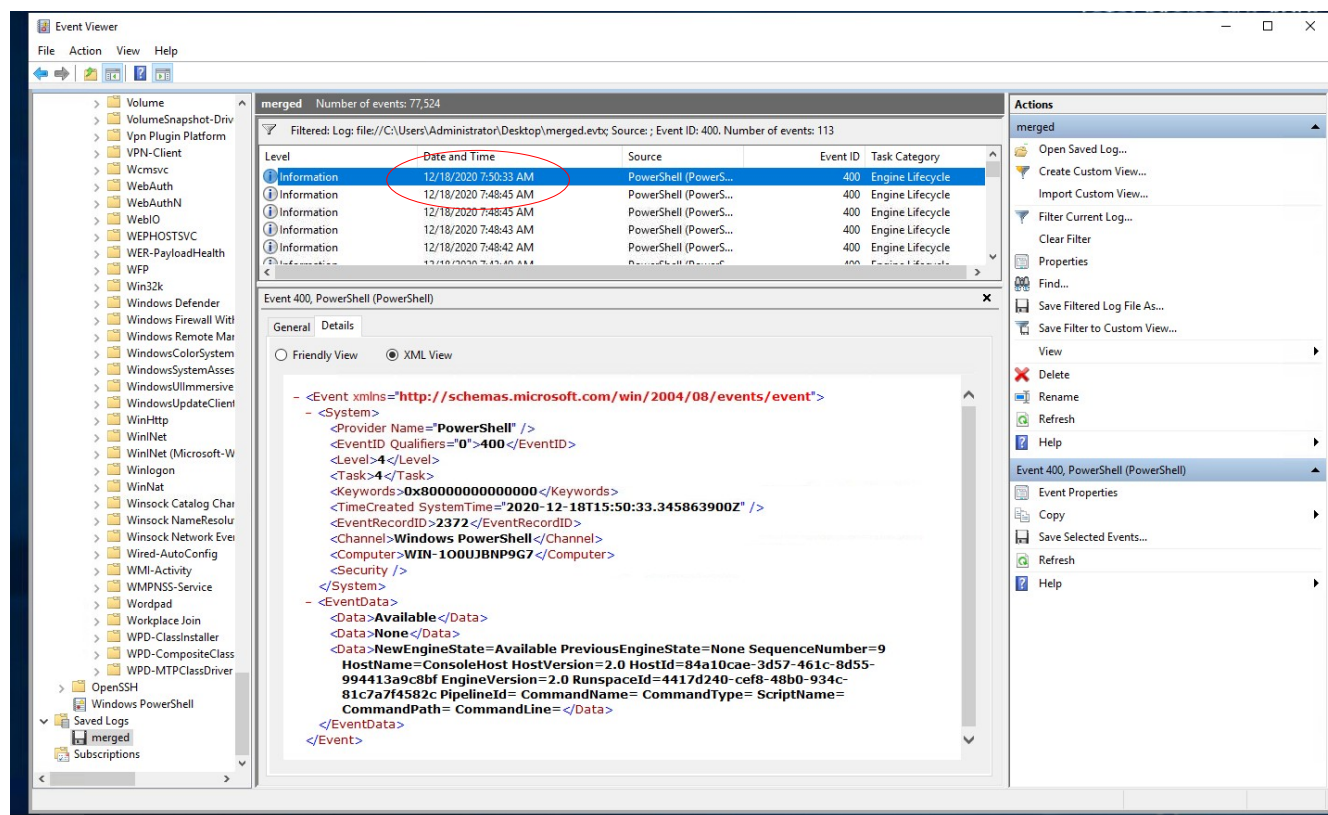


Event Viewer Management Powershell Downgrade Attack Example

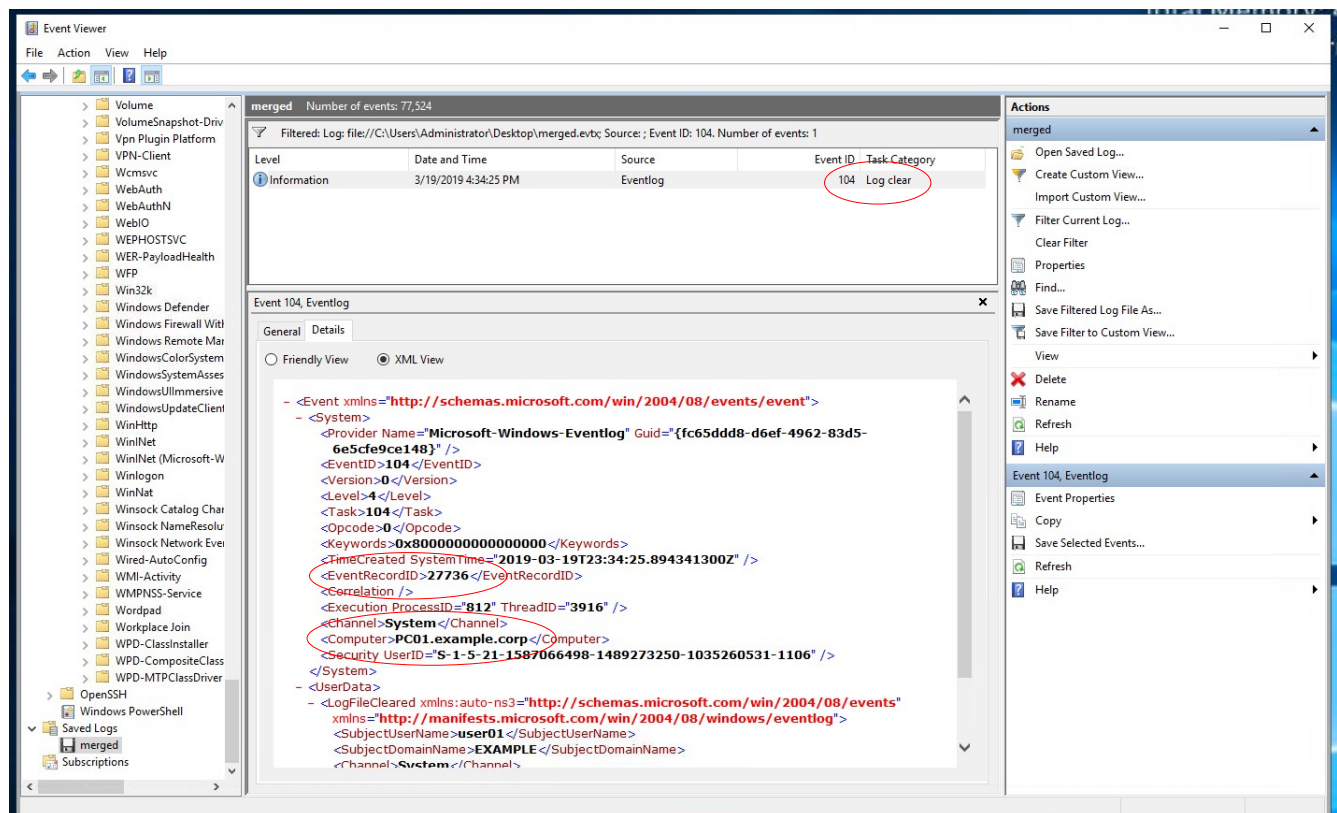
Scenario

Server admins have complaints of a Powershell being blocked in the environment. Management approved the use of PowerShell within this environment. My job as part of the Security Team was to use the Event Logs to monitor if the logs have been cleared. Using the merged.evtx log file on my desktop: **C:\Users\Administrator\Desktop\merged.evtx** I have used Windows Event Viewer to examine and find the blockage. I have used Google Search to find the event ID 400 to detect a PowerShell downgrade attack.

With this information, I then continued further my investigation on the date and time that this took place which was on 12/18/2020 at 7:50:33 AM just before the 8:00 AM day to start.



I then investigated further to find when the “log clear” was performed. I found the following information on the **Event ID (104)** which I once again used Google to find this “Event Log Manipulation” and listed under the Task Category on which the log was cleared. I have also noticed the **Event Record ID (27736)** and the computer name (**PC01.example.corp**) on the unit where this command was executed.



Summary

This is an example of how I can investigate attacks via logs by utilizing an Event Viewer instance. By doing so I have demonstrated how I can extract log files to find events such as a log clear event which can drastically slow down production and harm critical information in it's database not to mention a compromise which could lead to ruin a company's reputation, trust and possible financial damage.